Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

811
14 1.76%
Jul 22nd, 2025

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

923
15.00 1.65%
Jul 22nd, 2025

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

689
6 0.88%
Jul 22nd, 2025

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

104.67
1.37 1.33%
Jul 22nd, 2025

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

111.41
2.30 2.11%
Jul 22nd, 2025

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

915
15 1.67%
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2509 (September) RMB/t (3pm close)

823.00
14.00 1.73%
Jul 22nd, 2025 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
August 25 USD/dmt

105.35
1.80 1.74%
Jul 22nd, 2025 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2510 (Jan) RMB/t

3307
83 2.57%
Jul 22nd, 2025 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

22.87
0.08 0.4%
Jul 21st, 2025

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

9.52
-0.16 -1.6%
Jul 21st, 2025

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3201
34 1.06%
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

133.39
-2.77 -2.03%
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

18.02
-0.04 -0.19%
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3332
47 1.44%
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Jul 22nd, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	811	14	1.8%	778	839	683	1063	105.45	2.03	2.0%	100.56	109.26	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	689	6	0.9%	680	734	610	963	89.99	0.93	1.0%	88.32	96.13	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	923	15	1.7%	890	950	794	1175	120.49	2.14	1.8%	115.54	124.29	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Jul 22nd, 2025		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	104.67	1.37	1.33%	101.74	110.38	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	111.41	2.30	2.11%	111.29	124.74	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, the iron ore futures continued their strong upward trend, with the most-traded contract I2509 surging to 835.5 in the afternoon before pulling back to close at 823, marking a daily gain of 2.49%. Traders were actively offloading positions, while speculative trading remained weak. Some steel mills purchased as needed, but most adopted a cautious wait-and-see approach, with weak purchase willingness. The overall market sentiment was subdued. In Shandong, the mainstream transaction prices for PB fines were around 798 yuan/mt, up 13 yuan/mt from the previous day, while in Tangshan, PB fines traded at around 815 yuan/mt, up 15 yuan/mt. Anti-"rat race" policies and mega-project initiatives fueled sentiment in the ferrous metals series, driving futures prices sharply higher. Iron ore prices have already reached elevated levels, stoking market fears of a pullback. Given intensifying policy uncertainties and limited fundamental demand support, further upside appears constrained in the near term, warranting cautious trading.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	915	15	1.7%	896	974	820	1210	114.37	1.96	1.75%	111.61	122.15	102.77	153.57

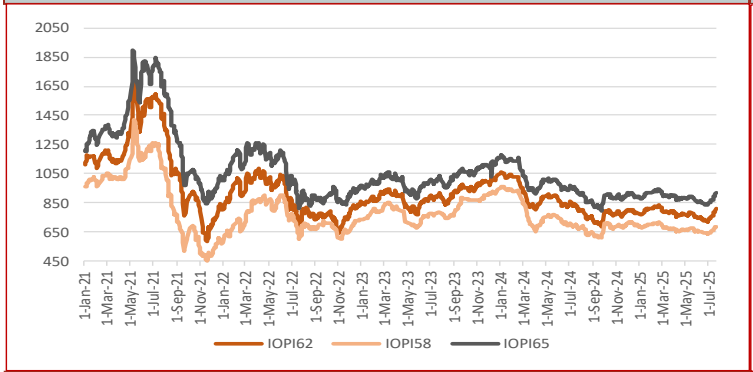
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	879	1.3%	859	1226	122.95	1.29%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	895	0.6%	880	1300	125.18	0.59%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	695	0.7%	690	970	97.21	0.75%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	901	1.5%	878	1294	126.02	1.49%	122.53	182.16

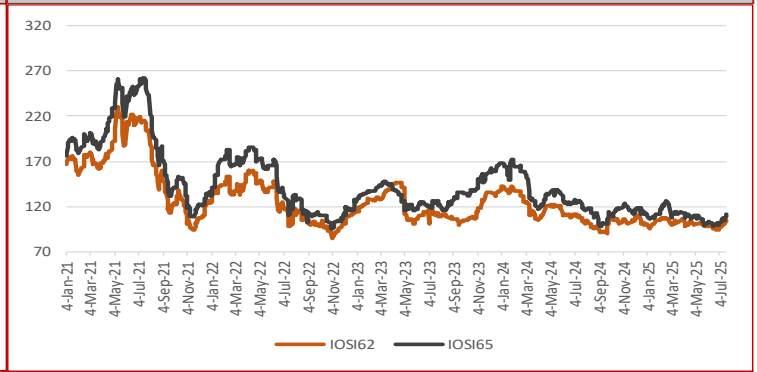
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	811.21	1.12%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jul 22nd, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	March	April	May	June	MTD	QTD	YTD	March	April	May	June	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	787	771	770	738	**778**	772	839	101.83	99.27	99.19	95.15	**100.56**	99.88	109.26
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	677	664	668	650	**680**	674	734	87.92	85.93	86.44	84.27	**88.32**	87.67	96.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	899	883	882	850	**890**	884	950	116.79	114.18	114.14	110.12	**115.54**	114.89	124.29

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jul 22nd, 2025		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	March	April	May	June	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	102.47	101.62	100.10	96.53	**101.74**	100.94	110.38
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	112.28	109.70	105.43	100.81	**111.29**	110.71	124.74

FREIGHT RATES

Jul 21st, 2025		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	9.52	-0.16	-1.6%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	22.87	0.08	0.4%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	March	April	May	June	MTD	QTD	YTD	March	April	May	June	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	905	901	898	865	**896**	890	974	112.70	111.81	111.39	107.50	**111.61**	110.93	122.15

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Jul 22nd, 2025		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	**-122**	-15.04%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	**112**	13.81%

Jul 22nd, 2025		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	**6.74**	6.44%

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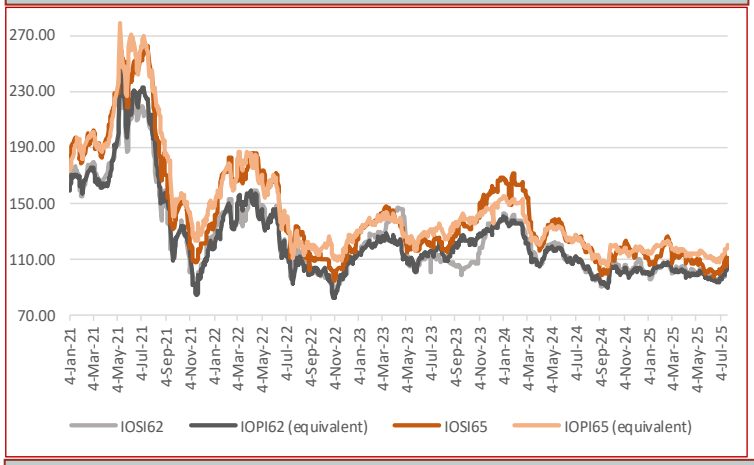
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Jul 22nd, 2025	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	754	14	-57
SIMEC Fines	682	15	-129
PB Fines	780	14	-31
Newman Fines	779	14	-32
MAC Fines	761	14	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	675	14	-136
Carajas Fines	991	14	180
Brazilian SSF	773	14	-38
Brazilian Blend Fines	793	13	-18
RTX Fines	694	14	-117
West Pilbara Fines	723	14	-88

Jul 22nd, 2025	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.15	1.35	-4.52
SIMEC Fines	96.65	1.35	-8.02
PB Fines	100.90	1.35	-3.77
Newman Fines	103.80	1.35	-0.87
MAC Fines	100.90	1.35	-3.77
Jimblebar Blended Fines	93.30	1.35	-11.37
Carajas Fines	134.20	1.35	29.53
Brazilian SSF	108.40	1.35	3.73
Brazilian Blend Fines	110.03	1.38	5.36
RTX Fines	94.55	1.40	-10.12
West Pilbara Fines	98.90	1.35	-5.77

Jul 22nd, 2025	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	690	7	1
FMG Blended Fines	698	7	9
Robe River	699	7	10
Western Fines	702	8	13
Atlas Fines	696	7	7
Yandi	684	7	-5

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	13.00	2.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	8.00	-3.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	10.00	3.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	25.00	-5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	28.00	6.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	-2.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	6.00	1.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	7.00	0.75
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	0.50	0.25
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	0.50	0.25
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	0.50	0.25
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	2.50	-0.25
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	0.50	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.50	-0.25
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	0.50	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.00	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-50.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-20.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-5.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-15.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-10.00	0.00

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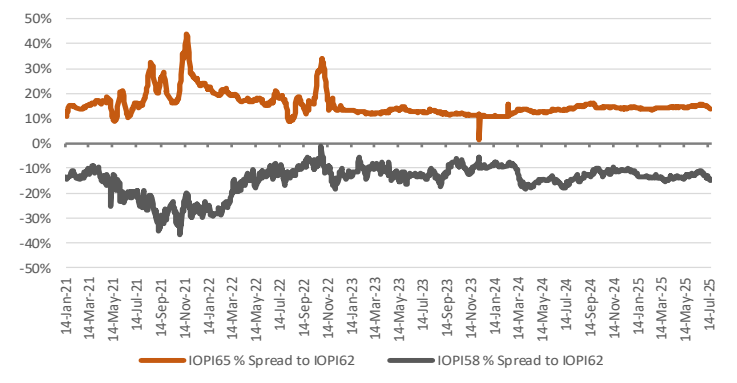
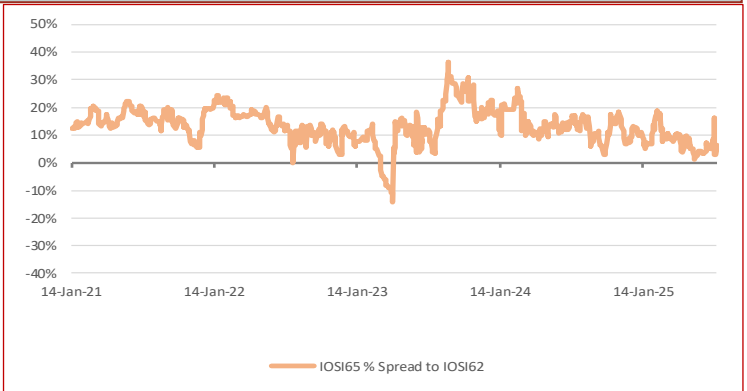
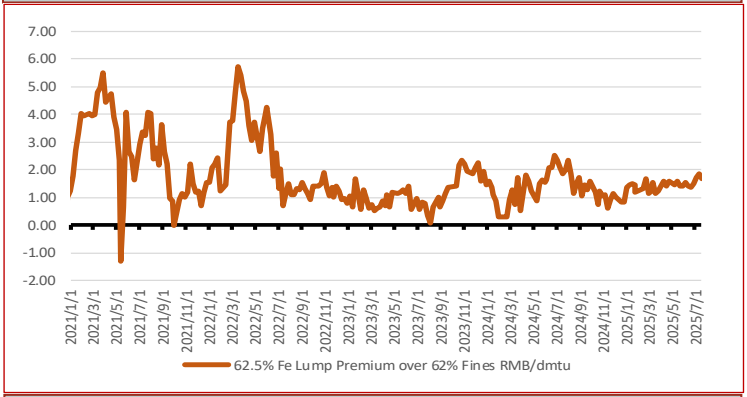
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

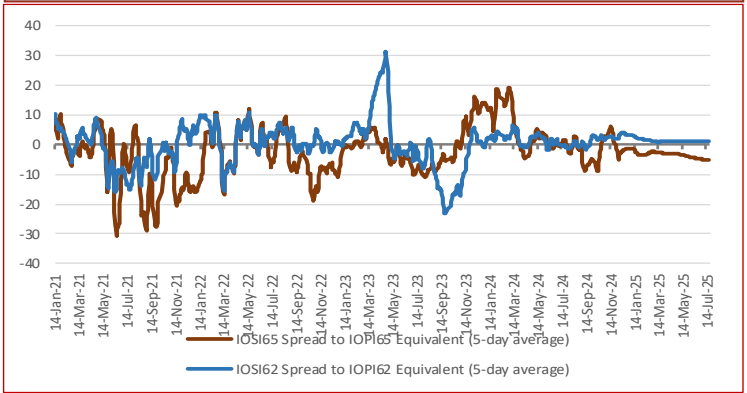




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

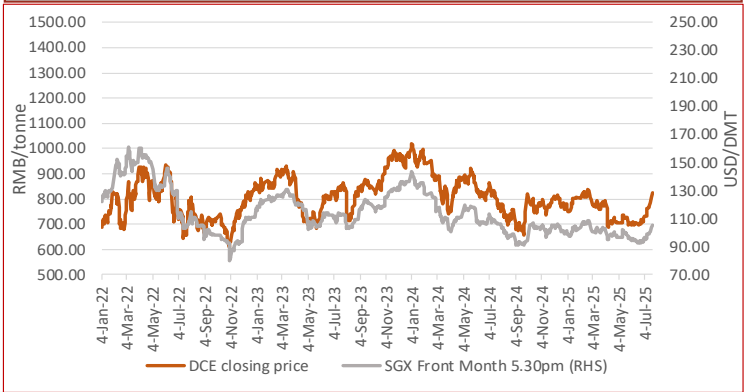


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

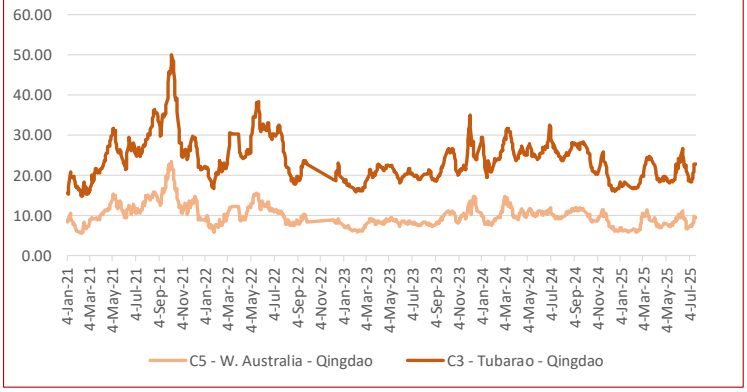
Week Ending Jul 18th, 2025

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	12.92	-1.22%	8.29	17.20
Qingdao	28.71	1.06%	22.28	28.75
Caofeidian	13.58	-0.73%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	9.67	-0.51%	6.64	12.36
Rizhao	14.52	-5.84%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	133.39	-2.03%	105.01	150.72

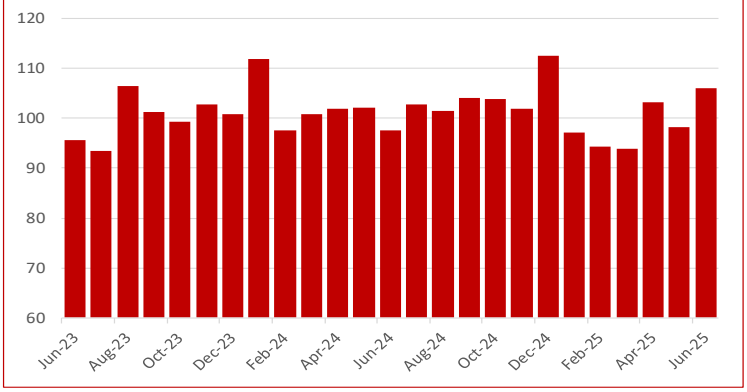
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Jul 22nd, 3pm close			Jul 22nd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2509	Change	Change %	Aug. 25	Change	Change %
Closing Price	823.00	14.00	1.73%	105.35	1.80	1.74%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	59.33	0.96	1.65%	10.96	0.97	9.65%
Open positions ('000 lots)	61.99	-4.35	-6.56%	45.31	-0.88	-1.91%
Day Low	805.0	19.50	2.48%	103.10	2.35	2.33%
Day High	835.5	16.50	2.01%	107.00	2.20	2.10%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2025/07/18	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,201	34	1.06%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,360	27	0.82%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,332	47	1.44%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,727	44	1.19%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,433	30	0.88%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,270	25	0.59%
Colour Coated Plate	6,550	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

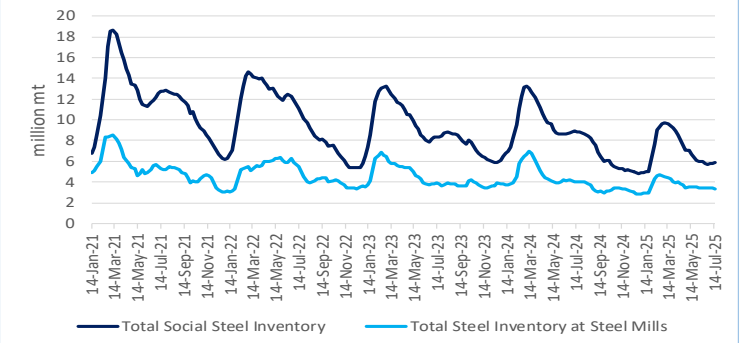
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	101.75	5.46	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,385	55	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,440	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,441	62	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	2,985	70	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	175	-20	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,066	70	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	274	-30	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

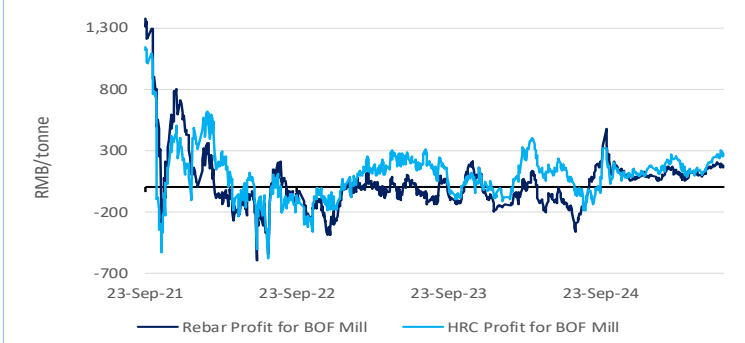
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

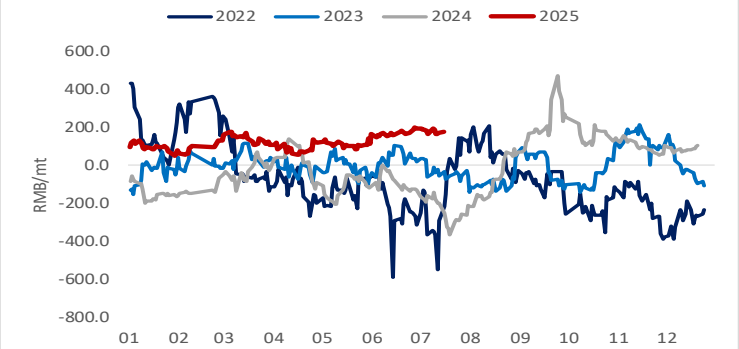
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



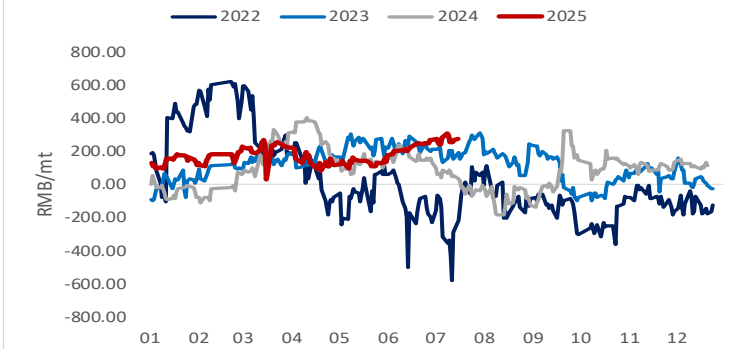
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



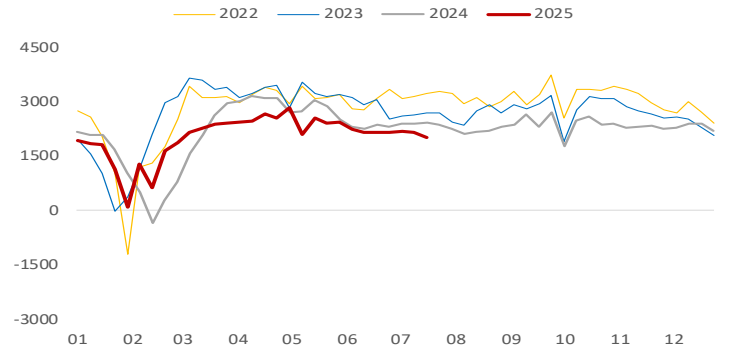
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



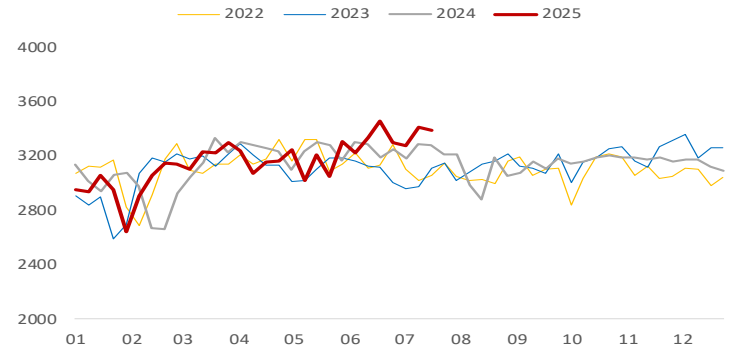
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



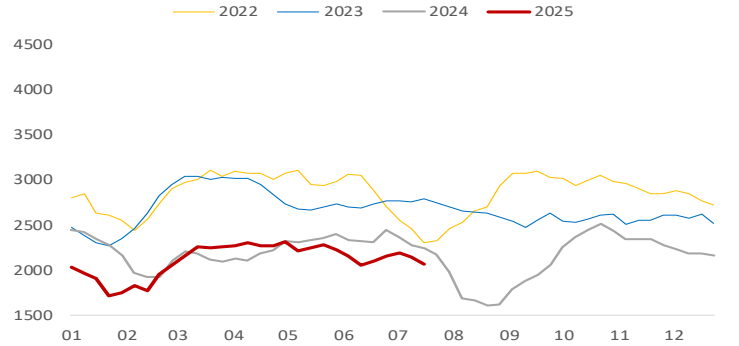
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



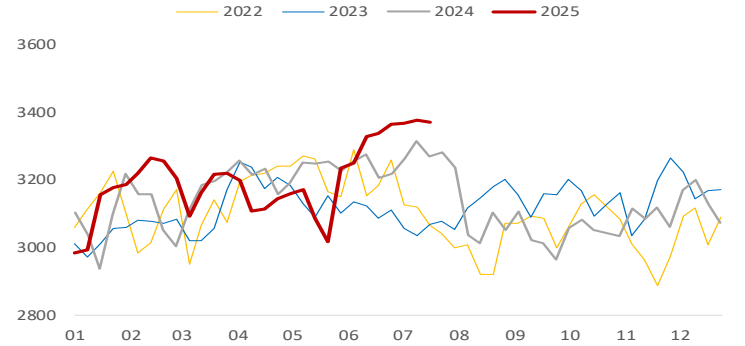
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Jul 22nd, 2025	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Jul 22nd, 2025	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

CONTACT US

MMI Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7629 E: prices@mmiprices.com
SMM Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7630 E: service.en@smm.cn
SMM Shanghai Office Details: 9th FL, Building 9, Lujiazui Software Park, No.20, Lane 91, Pudong, Shanghai Tel: +86 021 5155 0306 E: service.en@smm.cn

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